# History Week 2: Rework your education paragraph

Year 8 History · Rome · Skill: So What? | About 25 minutes, by hand | Name: _____ Date: _____

**Today is not new facts. It is one paragraph, done carefully.** Use your Rome reference page. Everything in your Evidence box must come from the page or your class notes.

**Question:** How far did a Roman child's life depend on the family they were born into?

## 1 · Evidence bank (5 min) [3 facts]

Pick **three** facts about childhood or houses that show *family* mattering. Write them in your own words. Tick where each came from.

| Fact (your words, with a name, a type of house, or a detail) | Where from? |
|---|---|
| | ☐ page ☐ class notes ☐ not sure |
| | ☐ page ☐ class notes ☐ not sure |
| | ☐ page ☐ class notes ☐ not sure |

## 2 · Your So What (3 min) [1 sentence]

Choose your best fact. Finish one sentence that says what it **tells us about family**. Starters: *This suggests that... · This reveals... · Underlying this was the idea that...*

Test: can you point back at the fact and show how the sentence follows? If not, it is a guess. Try again.

## 3 · Write the paragraph (12 min) [P · E · SW · L]

**P** answer the question in sentence one (use the word *family*) · **E** your fact · **SW** your So What · **L** tie back: "So how far did it depend on family? ...". Label each sentence P / E / SW / L in the margin.

## 4 · Claim check (3 min)

Look at the facts in your paragraph. For each one, tick one box. If it is not on your page, that is fine: write “not sure” beside it and ask your teacher.

| Claim in my paragraph | On the reference page | From class notes | Not sure: ask teacher |
|---|---|---|---|
| | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |
| | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ |

## Self-check (5 min)

- ☐ Sentence one answers the question and uses the word **family**.
- ☐ My Evidence is a specific fact from the page or my notes (not “lots of people”).
- ☐ My So What says what the fact **tells us**. I can point back at the fact to show how it follows.
- ☐ My last sentence returns to “how far” and gives an answer (a lot, partly, hardly).
- ☐ I did not add a fact that is not backed up. Anything unsure is marked.

## Oral check (5 min, with a parent)

Say it out loud, from memory if you can. Parent asks: **“So what does that tell us about how far a child's life depended on family?” (She answers without reading the paragraph.)**

Parent tick: ☐ answered without reading it ☐ answered with a prompt ☐ could not yet

## Weekly review (for J, 5 min)

| | |
|---|---|
| **Did she recognise a So What this week? Which one?** | |
| **What was weak this week?** | |
| **What worked?** | |
| **Time taken (HTML / written / total)** | |
| **One change for next week** | |

# Parent page: what to look for

**One habit this week: So What?** The coaching profile says she attempts So Whats but they are often tangential, guessed, or not tied to the question. She also labelled her best So What as a Fact last time, so recognising one is part of the job.

| Look for | Stronger sign | Weaker sign |
|---|---|---|
| Opening | Sentence one answers “how far” and uses *family* | Starts with a fact or a definition |
| Evidence | A fact from the page, in her words | A fact from memory that contradicts the page |
| So What | Points back at the evidence and answers the question about family | A restatement, a feeling the page never mentions, or a different topic |
| Link | Gives an answer (“a great deal, because…”) | Ends on another fact |

**Level cue (AQA-style, for a paragraph this size):** Level 2 is some explanation, with evidence that is generic or only partly relevant. Level 3 is developed explanation with specific, relevant evidence. One grounded So What tied to the question is what moves a paragraph from the first to the second.

**Model So Whats (shape, not to copy):**
• Fact: poor children usually had no formal schooling. *This suggests that a poor child's future was largely set by their family's situation, because the family needed their work more than their education.*
• Fact: fathers held patria potestas over adult children. *This suggests that a child's whole life was shaped by the father they were born to, because his legal power did not end when they grew up.*

**If she is stuck:** ask the oral question about one fact at a time. If she answers well aloud but writes a flat sentence, the skill is there and she is not prompting herself in writing. If she cannot answer aloud, it is still the skill that needs teaching. Please write that down in the review box.

**Does she move on?** Not yet. The coaching profile needs most Evidence sentences followed by a grounded So What across two pieces in a row, plus an oral answer without reading.